

Unit 4



What's next?

Inglés Profesional

4



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Introduction

In this unit, you will explore how to **compare things** using **comparative** and **superlative adjectives**, such as describing something as **better**, **the best**, or **worse**. You will also examine **prepositions of movement**, which allow you to talk about going **to**, **from**, or **through** different places. Additionally, you will focus on **expressing purpose**, explaining **why** actions are done, and using the **imperative form** to give precise instructions. Finally, you will dive into various **future tenses**, learning how to talk about future actions, **predictions**, **plans**, and **promises** using structures like **"will"**, **"going to"**, **"present continuous"**, and **"future perfect"**. Mastering these areas will significantly enhance your **communication skills** in **professional contexts**.



4.1.

Comparative and superlative adjectives

First of all, before introducing **comparative** and **superlative** adjectives, we will look at the meaning of an **adjective**.

An **adjective** is a word that describes a **person, place, or thing (noun)**. It gives more information about it.

Examples:

- > A big house. (Big tells us about the house.)
- > She is happy. (Happy tells us how she feels.)
- > This is a red apple. (Red tells us the color of the apple.)

Adjectives answer questions like:

- > What kind? (A small car, a tall boy)
- > How many? (Two dogs, many friends)
- > What color? (A blue dress, green eyes)

4.1.1. Comparative adjectives

We use **comparative adjectives** when we want to **compare two things**. This means we want to say that one thing is bigger, faster, more beautiful, etc., than the other.

How to form comparative adjectives?

- > For one-syllable adjectives, simply add '-er' to the adjective to form its comparative:
 - » Soft → Softer
 - » Tall → Taller
 - » Fast → Faster
- > For one-syllable adjectives ending in '-e', just add '-r':
 - » Wise → Wiser
 - » Safe → Safer
 - » Nice → Nicer
- > For one-syllable adjectives ending in consonant + vowel + consonant, double the final consonant and add '-er':
 - » Red → Redder
 - » Fit → Fitter
 - » Big → Bigger



- > For adjectives with two or more syllables, add 'more' before the adjective to form its comparative:
 - » Polite → More polite
 - » Expensive → More expensive
 - » Famous → More famous
- > For two-syllable adjectives ending in '-y', remove the '-y' and add '-ier':
 - » Noisy → Noisier
 - » Busy → Busier
 - » Easy → Easier
- > For adjectives ending in '-ed', add 'more' before the adjective to form the comparative:
 - » Interested → More interested
 - » Excited → More excited
 - » Bored → More bored

4.1.2. Superlative adjectives

Superlative adjectives are used to say that something has **the most or least of a quality** compared to three or more things.

How to form superlative adjectives?

1. **For one-syllable adjectives:** Add -est to the adjective.
 - » Tall → Tallest
 - » Fast → Fastest
2. **For adjectives that end in -e:** Add -st.
 - » Safe → Safest
 - » Wise → Wisest
3. **For adjectives ending in -y:** Change the y to -iest.
 - » Happy → Happiest
 - » Noisy → Noisiest
4. **For adjectives with more than two syllables:** Use the most before the adjective.
 - » Interesting → The most interesting
 - » Expensive → The most expensive



4.1.3. Irregular adjectives

Some adjectives do **not follow the regular rules** for forming superlatives. Instead, they have completely different forms that must be **memorized**.

Adjective	Comparative	Superlative
Good	Better	The best
Bad	Worse	The worst
Far	Farther/Further	The farthest/The furthest
Little	Less	The least
Much/Many	More	The most

Review

	Adjective	Comparative	Superlative
One syllable	strong	stronger	strongest
Consonant + short vowel + consonant	big	bigger	biggest
Ends in -e	large	larger	largest
Ends in -y	happy	happier	happiest
Two syllables	gentle	gentler / more gentle	gentlest / most gentle
Three or more syllables	expensive	more expensive	most expensive
Irregular forms	good / little	better / less	best / least

💡 RECUERDA

Los **comparativos** sirven para comparar dos cosas, mientras que los **superlativos** indican cuál es el mejor o peor de todos. Se forman siguiendo reglas sencillas, excepto las formas irregulares, que deben memorizarse.





4.2.

Prepositions of movement

A **preposition of movement** is a word that indicates direction or the path of movement. These prepositions are commonly used with verbs such as go, walk, run, drive, fly, move, and swim.

We use prepositions after these verbs to describe the direction of movement. They appear in sentences that show movement from one place to another.

Example:

- > The bus drove across the bridge.
- > I sent a postcard to my mother.
- > We walked past the restaurant.

4.2.1. Common prepositions of movement

Some of the most common prepositions of movement are:

Preposición	Significado
To-toward(s)	a, hacia
Off	de, a lo lejos, caerse, fuera de
Over	sobre, encima de, arriba de
Past	por, por delante de
Up	subir, hacia arriba
Down	bajar, hacia abajo
Across	al otro lado de
Into	en, dentro de
From...to	desde...a / hasta
Through	a través de, por
Along	a lo largo de, por
Around	por todo, alrededor de
Away	en otra dirección, alejarse
Back	de vuelta/ regreso, hacia atrás



4.2.2. Building sentences with directions and movement

A prepositional phrase of movement tells us where someone or something moves.

It usually includes:

- > a verb of movement (e.g. go, walk, run, throw, send),
- > a preposition of movement (from the list above),
- > and a place or destination.

Structure:

Subject + verb of movement +
preposition of movement + place

Example:

- > **the cat** (subject) + **jumped** (verb) + **into** (preposition) + **the box** (place)
- > **he** (subject) + **walked** (verb) + **along** (preposition) + **the beach** (place)
- > **we** (subject) + **ran** (verb) + **through** (preposition) + **the park** (place)

These phrases usually come after the verb and the object.

Structure with object:

subject + verb + object + preposition + place

Example:

she (**subject**) threw (**verb**) the rubbish (**object**) into (**preposition**) the bin (**place**).

✓ She threw the rubbish into the bin.

✗ She threw into the bin the rubbish.



RECUERDA

Las preposiciones de movimiento indican **hacia dónde se mueve algo o alguien**.

Se forman con un **verbo de movimiento + preposición de movimiento + lugar**



4.3.

Expressing purpose

We can use different forms of verbs to talk about why we do something. These forms help us explain the purpose of an action.

4.3.1 Infinitive and gerund

First of all, let's look at what an infinitive and a gerund are. We use them to talk about the purpose of an action.

Infinitive

The infinitive is the basic form of a verb. It usually comes with the word to.

> **Examples:**

- » to eat
- » to run
- » to study

> Sentence example: I want **to eat** an apple.

Gerund

A gerund is a verb that ends in -ing and works like a noun.

> **Examples:**

- » eating
- » running
- » studying

> Sentence example: **Running** is good for your health.

Review:

	Gerund	Infinitive
What are Gerunds and Infinitives?	A gerund is a verb which ends in " -ing " and is used as a noun. + the gerund "running"	An infinitive is a verb which is preceded by "to" and is used as a verb. + the infinitive "to run"
Difference	1. We use a gerund as a noun, while an infinitive is used as a verb. + the gerund "running" can be used as a noun, while the infinitive "to run" is used as a verb. 2. Other differences include how they are used in a sentence and how they are formed.	
Examples	+ She loves swimming (Gerund) + I like reading books (Gerund)	+ I need to go shopping (Infinitive) + He helped me (to) understand the lesson (Infinitive)



4.3.2. Using "to" and "for" for purpose

We can show the **purpose** of an action using **two main structures**: *to + infinitive* and *for + gerund*. Both forms explain why something is done, but they work a bit differently.

Using "to" + Infinitive

We use this form to explain a clear goal or purpose.

> **Example:** I listen to podcasts to improve my listening skills.

(Here, the infinitive to improve shows the specific reason for listening.)

Using "for" + Gerund

When we use + gerund, we describe the general purpose or function of something.

> **Example:** This tool is for weeding the garden.

(Here, the gerund weeding explains the general use of the tool.)

Using "for" + Object

Sometimes, we use for with a noun or object to explain why we went somewhere or did something.

> **Example:**

» **Question:** Why did you go to the mountains?

» **Answer:** I went there for fresh air.

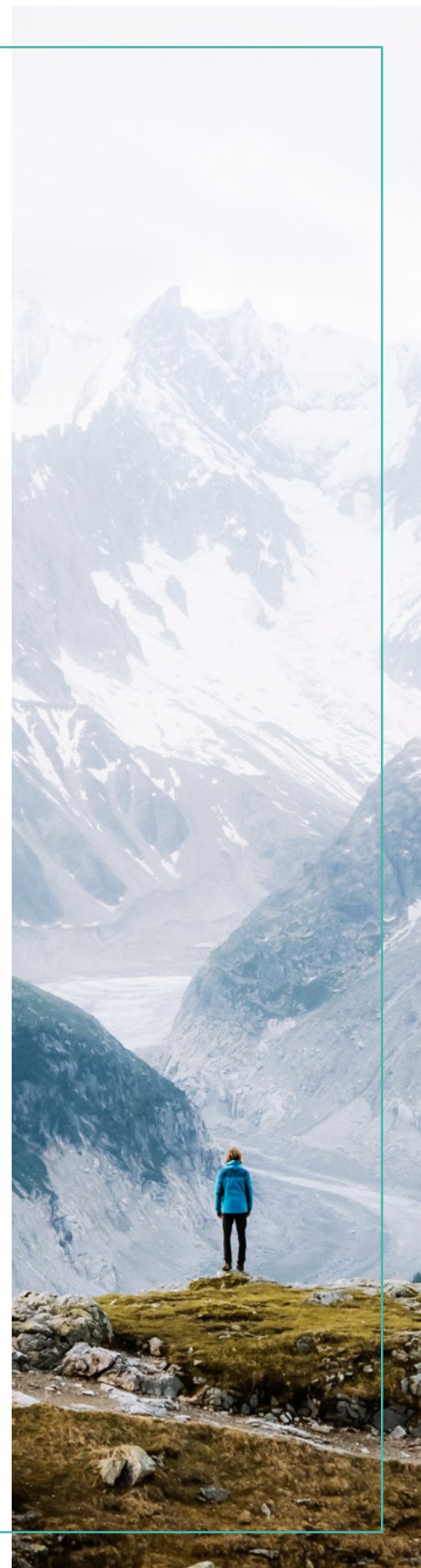
We can also use to + infinitive for the same purpose:

» I went to get fresh air.



RECUERDA

Para expresar propósito en inglés, usamos **"to" + infinitivo** para objetivos claros (ej. I study **to** learn), y **"for" + gerundio** para describir la función general de algo (ej. This tool is **for** cutting paper).





4.4.

The imperative

The **imperative** is used to give **commands, instructions, or requests**. It is a direct way of telling someone what to do or not to do. In the imperative, the verb is in its base form (without "to"), and there is no subject because it is understood that the command is directed at the person or people you are speaking to.

Key points

- > **No subject:** The subject is understood as "you" (singular or plural).
 - » **Example:** Sit down. (You sit down.)
 - » **Example:** Listen to me. (You listen to me.)
- > **No "to":** Use the base form of the verb without the word "to."
 - » **Correct:** Eat your dinner.
 - » **Incorrect:** To eat your dinner.
- > **Used for:**
 - » **Orders:** Giving direct instructions or telling someone what to do.
 - + **Example:** Finish your homework.
 - » **Advice:** Giving suggestions or helpful tips.
 - + **Example:** Drink plenty of water.
 - » **Warnings:** Giving a caution or alert about something.
 - + **Example:** Be careful with that knife.
 - » **Requests:** Politely asking someone to do something.
 - + **Example:** Please pass me the salt.
 - » **Instructions:** Giving a step-by-step guide or explanation.
 - + **Example:** First, open the box.
 - » **Questions:** Using the imperative to ask for something in a polite manner.
 - + **Example:** Could you please close the door?
 - » **Same form for singular and plural:** The imperative form doesn't change whether you're talking to one person or a group.
 - + **Example (singular):** Give me the book.
 - + **Example (plural):** Give us the books.
 - » **Negative commands:** To give a negative command, use "don't" followed by the base form of the verb.
 - + **Example:** Don't touch that.
 - + **Example:** Don't speak loudly.

RECUERDA

El imperativo se usa para dar órdenes, consejos o instrucciones, y suele formarse con el verbo en infinitivo sin "to" ("Go!", "Listen!"). Para ser más cortés, se añade "please" ("Please sit down").



4.5.

The future

We use different structures to talk about the future, depending on what we want to express. The future is used to talk about things that will happen. Some forms are used for predictions, others for plans, and some for fixed schedules. The most common ways to talk about the future are "will," "be going to," the present continuous, and the present simple.

4.5.1. Future simple

The **future simple** tense is used to **talk about actions or events** that will happen **in the future**. It's the easiest way to talk about the future in English.

We use the word "will" to show that something is going to happen. You don't need to change the verb, just add "will" before the action.

> For example:

- » I will go to the park tomorrow.
(This means I am planning to go, or it will happen.)
- » My dad will regret buying that shirt.
(This means he will feel bad about it later.)
- » Katie will start university in September.
(This is something planned for the future.)

Key points

Structure:

> Affirmative sentences:

Subject + will + base form of the verb

- » **Example:** I will study tomorrow.

> Negative sentences:

Subject + will not (won't) + base form of the verb

- » **Example:** She will not (won't) come to the party.

> Questions:

Will + subject + base form of the verb?

- » **Example:** Will they visit us next summer?

POSITIVE	Subject + will + verb
NEGATIVE	Subject + will not (won't) + base form of the verb
QUESTION	Will + subject + base form of the verb?



Uses of "will"

1. **Predictions:** We use *will* to talk about things we think will happen in the future.
» **Example:** *I think it will rain tomorrow.*
2. **Promises:** We use *will* when we make a promise.
» **Example:** *I will always support you.*
3. **Decisions made at the moment of speaking:** We use *will* to talk about things we decide to do right now.
» **Example:** *I'll have a coffee, please.*
(deciding while ordering)



RECUERDA

El futuro simple se usa para hablar de cosas que sucederán. Usamos "will" + verbo en su forma base para predicciones, promesas y decisiones tomadas en el momento.

4.5.2. To be going to

We use **going to** to talk about **personal plans or intentions**. For example, if you have a week of vacation, you may have some activities planned, or you may decide to relax and have fun. This is an intention because you decided it yourself.

Key points

Structure:

> Affirmative:

Subject + verb "to be" + going to + base form of the verb

» **Example:** I am going to travel next summer.

> Negative:

Subject + verb "to be" + not + going to + base form of the verb

» **Example:** She is not (isn't) going to buy a new car.

> Interrogative:

Verb "to be" + subject + going to + base form of the verb?

» **Example:** Are they going to watch a movie tonight?

Remember

We use "going to" when we already have a plan or decision for the future

> Structure review:

- » I → am going to
- » You, we, they → are going to
- » He, she, it → is going to

> Examples:

- » I am going to have fun on vacation. (Affirmative)
- » She is not going to break up with her boyfriend. (Negative)
- » Are they going to try to have a baby? (Question)



RECUERDA

Usamos "going to" para hablar de planes personales o intenciones futuras que ya hemos decidido. Su estructura varía según la afirmación, negación o pregunta, utilizando el verbo "to be" antes de "going to" y la forma base del verbo.



4.5.3. Present continuous for future arrangements

We use **the present continuous** to talk about **fixed plans or arrangements in the near future**. This is commonly used for events that have been scheduled, such as meetings, appointments, or social events.

Key points

Structure:

> Affirmative:

Subject + "to be" (am/is/are) + verb (-ing) + time expression

» **Example:** I am meeting my friends tomorrow.

> Negative:

Subject + "to be" (am/is/are) + not + verb (-ing) + time expression

» **Example:** She isn't traveling next weekend.

> Interrogative:

"To be" (am/is/are) + subject + verb (-ing) + time expression?

» **Example:** Are they coming to the party tonight?

Remember

> Present continuous is used when the event is already planned and confirmed.

» Examples:

- + We are having dinner with Sarah on Friday.
- + He is not playing football this evening.
- + Is she visiting her grandparents next weekend?

Use **time expressions** to clarify the future meaning:

- > **Tomorrow** → I'm meeting my friend tomorrow.
- > **Next week/month/year** → She is traveling to Paris next week.
- > **On + day of the week** → We are having a meeting on Monday.
- > **This evening/afternoon/morning** → They are going to the cinema this evening.
- > **At + specific time** → I am having dinner with Anna at 7 PM.
- > **In + a period of time** → He is leaving in two hours.
- > **The day after tomorrow** → She is starting her new job the day after tomorrow.



RECUERDA

Usamos el **present continuous** con valor de futuro para hablar de planes fijos o arreglos confirmados, como reuniones o eventos.

Su estructura sigue el verbo "to be" + verbo en "-ing" y suele ir acompañado de expresiones de tiempo para indicar el futuro.



4.5.4. Present simple for scheduled events

We use the **present simple** to **talk about fixed schedules** or timetables in the future. This is common for transportation, events, or official programs that follow a regular timetable.

Structure:

> Affirmative:

Subject + base verb (3rd person adds -s) + time expression

» **Example:** The train leaves at 8 AM.

> Negative:

Subject + do/does not + base verb + time expression

» **Example:** The shop doesn't open on Sundays.

> Interrogative:

Do/Does + subject + base verb + time expression?

» **Example:** Does the movie start at 6 PM?

Remember:

We use the present simple for the future with fixed schedules (public transport, cinemas, classes, official events, etc.).

Use **time expressions** like:

- > **Specific times** → *The train **leaves at 9 AM**.*
(at + exact time)
- > **Days of the week** → *Our class **starts on Monday**.*
(on + day)
- > **Fixed dates** → *The conference **begins on March 5th**.*
(on + date)
- > **Future periods** → *The new schedule **takes effect next week**.*
(next week/month/year)
- > **Short future intervals** → *The ferry **departs in two hours**.*
(in + period of time)

Examples

- > The flight arrives at noon.
- > The bus doesn't leave at night.
- > What time does the concert start?

The **present simple for the future** is used when an event follows a **set timetable** that does not change.

RECUERDA

Usamos el **present simple** para hablar de horarios y planes fijos en el futuro, como trenes, clases o eventos.

Usamos palabras como "**at 9 AM**" (a las 9), "**on Monday**" (el lunes) o "**next week**" (la próxima semana) para decir cuándo pasa algo.



4.5.5. Future perfect

Future perfect is used to say that something **will be finished before a certain time in the future.**

Structure:

Subject + will have + past participle

- > **Affirmative:** *By 10 p.m., I will have finished my homework.*
(Before 10 p.m., my homework will be done.)
- > **Negative:** *She will not have arrived by noon.*
(She won't be here before noon.)
- > **Question:** *Will you have finished by Friday?*
(Will it be done before Friday?)

Remember

We use the future perfect:

- > **To talk about something that will be finished before a time in the future.**

By next year, we will have moved to a new house.
(Next year, we will already live in a new house.)
- > **To imagine the past from a future time.**

By the time you wake up, I will have left.
(When you wake up, I will already be gone.)

Time words with the future perfect

- > **By + time** → *by Monday, by 2025, by 6 p.m.*
- > **Before + event** → *before dinner, before the weekend*



RECUERDA

El **futuro perfecto** se usa para hablar de acciones que **se habrán completado antes de un momento específico en el futuro**. Se forma con **"will have" + participio pasado** (By 2025, I will have finished my degree). Se usa con expresiones como **"by"** (para, antes de) y **"before"** (antes de). Se diferencia del futuro simple porque enfatiza que la acción estará terminada antes de un punto en el futuro.





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